

# Germany

Sovereign government data centre network — capacity, legal posture, provider landscape and migration path.

## 1 Starting point

|                                |               |
|--------------------------------|---------------|
| Population                     | 83.58 m       |
| GDP                            | EUR 4,470 bn  |
| Public administration (NACE O) | 3,041 k       |
| Electricity price              | 226.4 EUR/MWh |
| Renewables                     | 54.1%         |
| Live hyperscaler regions       | 6             |

## 2 What is structurally different

- Expensive power (226 EUR/MWh vs. EU average ~184). Power is the dominant OPEX line; free cooling, heat reuse, and siting near renewables or nuclear baseload move the economics more than server choice does. The model's power OPEX line is the number to attack first.
- Dense hyperscaler presence (6 live regions). Commercial capacity, fibre and skills exist in-country; the sovereign core can stay lean and the hybrid model works as designed. The risk is the opposite one: political pressure to declare a hyperscaler region 'sovereign enough' (Dutch GOAL.md section 17: location is not sovereignty).

## 3 Capacity

|                      |                                                 |
|----------------------|-------------------------------------------------|
| Servers              | 24,531 (CPU 16,916 / GPU 1,146 / storage 6,469) |
| IT critical load     | 40.3 MW                                         |
| Facility design load | 60.4 MW                                         |
| Sites                | 6 (by capacity 6, floor 4)                      |
| Average per site     | 10.1 MW                                         |
| Site count set by    | capacity                                        |
| CAPEX                | EUR 1.44 bn                                     |
| OPEX                 | EUR 164 m / yr                                  |

## 4 Proposed geography

| Region                 | Role                | Share | MW   | Notes                                                                            |
|------------------------|---------------------|-------|------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Frankfurt - Rhine-Main | Primary civil cloud | 36%   | 21.7 | DE-CIX, ITZBund estate; grid saturated - expect multi-year connection lead time. |

| Region               | Role                    | Share | MW   | Notes                                                                    |
|----------------------|-------------------------|-------|------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Berlin - Brandenburg | Sovereign secondary     | 18%   | 10.9 | Federal ministries, AWS ESC and STACKIT prove grid headroom in the east. |
| Munich / Bavaria     | Defense / industrial    | 18%   | 10.9 | Defense-industrial cluster, Bundeswehr IT; southern separation.          |
| Hamburg / North      | Government / continuity | 18%   | 10.9 | Wind surplus, North Sea cable landings (Norden/Sylt).                    |
| Leipzig - Saxony     | Strategic reserve       | 10%   | 6.0  | Post-coal land and grid; reserve/expansion.                              |

*First-pass geographic hypotheses encoding only the obvious constraints, to be replaced by scored site selection.*

## 5 Legal and regulatory posture

|                      |                                                                                   |
|----------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Governing instrument | Onlinezugangsgesetz; IT-Planungsrat Deutsche Verwaltungscloud-Strategie (DVC)     |
| Cloud certification  | BSI C5 (Cloud Computing Compliance Criteria Catalogue)                            |
| Data classification  | Verschlusssachenanweisung (VSA): VS-NfD / VS-Vertraulich / Geheim / Streng Geheim |
| Procurement route    | Beschaffungsamt des BMI and Kaufhaus des Bundes; ITZBund as federal operator      |

**Foreign jurisdiction exposure.** Delos Cloud (SAP/Arvato on Azure, BSI-aligned) for federal workloads; M365 use contested by the Datenschutzkonferenz

Under the US CLOUD Act and FISA 702 a provider subject to US jurisdiction can face a lawful order for data it holds regardless of where that data sits. Residency is necessary but not sufficient; what matters is who holds the keys and who can be compelled.

## 6 Current state and provider landscape

|                  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
|------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Government cloud | Deutsche Verwaltungscloud (DVC) federated launched Mar 2025 (IT-Planungsrat/govdigital/FITKO); Bundescloud (ITZBund); Delos Cloud (SAP/Arvato on Azure, BSI-aligned); openDesk (ZenDiS); STACKIT/IONOS/T-Cloud; BSI C5 |
| Maturity         | federated                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| Digital identity | Online-Ausweis eID + BundID/DeutschlandID                                                                                                                                                                              |
| Interconnection  | DE-CIX Frankfurt (world's largest) Hamburg Munich; Norden/Sylt/Rostock landings                                                                                                                                        |

## 7 Migration path and cost

| Phase | Scope                | MW   | CAPEX     | Cumulative | Hybrid |
|-------|----------------------|------|-----------|------------|--------|
| 1     | Sovereign core       | 14.7 | EUR 281 m | 20%        | no     |
| 2     | Security and defense | 18.8 | EUR 456 m | 51%        | no     |
| 3     | State record         | 10.5 | EUR 265 m | 70%        | no     |
| 4     | Elective             | 16.4 | EUR 433 m | 100%       | yes    |

Phase 1 is the number that matters: **EUR 281 m** for 14.7 MW, 20% of total CAPEX. That is the floor below which no hybrid arrangement helps — and it is a small fraction of the full build.

## 8 Geography and threat notes

Low seismic; Ahr/Rhine/Elbe floods (2021); Frankfurt grid saturated (multi-year waits) with headroom in Brandenburg/east; 3rd-highest EU power price; north-south grid bottlenecks; LNG gas import; NATO; sabotage/drone incidents at DCs 2024-25